

The Life Insurance Needs Worksheet

Find your household's real number in ten minutes. No salesman required

Most families guess at life insurance. They take whatever work offers, or a round number that sounded right. This worksheet walks the same four questions an adviser would ask, so the number you land on is yours, not a pitch. Grab last month's budget and your latest statements, and work top to bottom.

1 • Debt the household would still owe

Mortgage balance _____ \$

Car loans, credit cards, student loans, everything else _____ \$

2 • Income your family would need replaced

Your annual take-home income _____ \$

Years your family would need it (many families use 10 to 15) _____ x

If one parent stays home, put a real value on what they do: childcare, transportation, household management. That is income too.

3 • The kids

Education goal per child (trade school, college, a head start) _____ \$

Childcare years remaining, if a caregiver were gone _____ \$

4 • What you already have (subtract these)

Savings and investments your family could actually use _____ - \$

Life insurance you already own personally _____ - \$

Coverage through work (check the multiple: 1x or 2x salary is common) _____ - \$

Careful with the work policy. It usually ends when the job does, and it was sized by HR, not by your family's needs.

Your household's coverage gap

\$

If the gap surprised you, you are in the majority. Most American households carry a fraction of the coverage this math suggests. The fix is usually simpler and cheaper than people expect, especially while you are young and healthy.

Want a second set of eyes on your number? Free 20-minute review. Virtual, no pitch.

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